

good enough for anyone who has a taste for music.

The flat bass is the first let-down, and when the high sharps seem dulled, you quietly dislodge the earphones.

Of course, you can always connect the iPhone to your favourite high-end listening device. It is a standard 3.5mm audio jack, after all. But then, what do you do about incoming calls? It is simply too much trouble and rather inconvenient to have to take out your earphones, pick the phone out of your pocket, answer a call, hang up, pop your earphone back in, resume playing the song and place the phone back in your pocket. Invariably, we end up sticking with the iPhone's default earphones, no matter how the music sounds, because at least it has a built-in microphone.

Sennheiser saw this problem and has sought to address it with the launch of its new MM50 earphones for the iPhone, with a frequency range of 18,000 to 22,000 Hz.

The in-ear model has become quite popular recently and the MM50 sticks with it, effectively blocking out a lot of ambient noise. As with most in-ear headphones, the unit comes with three variant sizes for the ear sleeves.

The device, of course, is equipped with a microphone attachment with an omni-directional pickup pattern and a frequency range of 80-15,000 Hz. The button allows you to answer calls and hang up; although you still have no way of knowing who might be on the other end of the line.

A lot of microphone-equipped earphones have a weight distribution problem as the mike pulls at the two ears. Sennheiser has gone with the 'shorter on left, longer on right' wire design, which goes behind your neck and effectively distributes the weight. Nice!

The wire is sufficiently long, but does not look too sturdy. And the lack of a casing deducts further points when it comes to the safety of the earphones. Still, the longevity of the speakers is taken care of by the two year warranty they come with.

As for the quality of the sound output and the mic's sensitivity, it's a Sennheiser. Need we say more?

If you have gotten yourself an iPhone, do yourself a favour and pick this up. And yes, it works on Nokia phones too.